

Sucker lips

Lepidotes had a trick when it came to feeding. It could push out its jaw, in the same way a carp does today, and would then suck in prey such as shellfish. Shells proved no barrier to this fish's hard, peglike teeth.



*Today's carp are able to push forward their jaws, just as *Lepidotes* once did.*



DID YOU KNOW...?

Our teeth and the teeth of all vertebrates evolved from the scales of prehistoric fish. The scales of *Lepidotes* were covered in dentine and coated with enamel, the same material that makes up our teeth. Even the structure of these scales looks similar to human teeth.

